# Mentor Awards 2026

## Video Production Plan

### Hertfordshire Freemasons

**Reference:**
**Our Reference:**
**Reviewed by:** Dan O'Connell
**Prepared by:** Wes Pierce
**Version:** 1.1

**Prepare, Support, Guide and Enlighten**

# Revision Status

| Date | Status | Author | Revision |
|---|---|---|---|
| 02.04.2026 | First Draft | Wes Pierce | 1.1 |
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# 1. Key Personnel & Roles

| | |
|---|---|
| **Project Lead** | Wes Pierce |
| **On-Camera (Opening)** | Mark Butcher & Wes Pierce |
| **Videography & Editing** | Dan O'Connell |
| **Venue** | Cheshunt Masonic Halls |
| **Subject Pool** | Persons who have nominated a person for the Mentor Award |
| **Filming Sessions** | 2 dates (TBC), 3-hour window each |
| **Interview Slot Duration** | 30 minutes per person |

# 2. Strategic Objectives

This video will form a central feature of the Mentor Awards 2026 ceremony, celebrating the outstanding contribution of mentors across the Province of Hertfordshire. The production should be authentic, dignified, and emotionally resonant — honouring both the nominees and the craft of mentoring itself.

- Capture sincere, personal testimonials from individuals who have nominated a mentor
- Create a polished, professional video for the Provincial Awards ceremony
- Ensure nominees feel at ease on camera, producing natural and compelling footage
- Deliver a final edited piece suitable for presentation at the 2026 Awards event

# 3. On-Camera: Mark Butcher & Wes Pierce — Opening Segment

Before nominee testimonials begin, the video will open with a filmed segment featuring Mark Butcher and Wes Pierce speaking directly to camera, and/or in a face to face Smith and Jones Style. This segment provides context, gravitas, and purpose — anchoring the entire production within the values of the Province and setting the tone for everything that follows.

## FORMAT & STYLE

- Filmed at Cheshunt Masonic Halls on one of the two filming dates, ideally at the start of a session before nominees arrive
- Both Mark and Wes on camera together — a natural, conversational format rather than formal or scripted
- Dan to film: consider a two-shot as the primary setup, with individual close-up cutaways for each speaker

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- Duration: approximately 3–5 minutes of usable footage, which will edit down to 1–2 minutes in the final piece
- Tone: warm, authoritative, and sincere — this is a celebration, not a corporate announcement

## TALKING POINTS FOR MARK BUTCHER & WES PIERCE

The following themes should be covered between the two speakers. These are not scripted lines — they are prompts to guide a natural conversation on camera.

| Theme | What to Cover |
|---|---|
| **Why this video is happening** | The Mentor Awards 2026 is an opportunity for the Province to formally recognise those who quietly and selflessly give their time to guide others. This video exists to give voice to the people whose lives have been shaped by that guidance — and to ensure those mentors know the profound difference they have made. |
| **What the video hopes to achieve** | To celebrate mentoring in a way that is lasting and visible. To inspire others across the Province to step forward as mentors themselves. To create a record of excellence that reflects the best of Hertfordshire Freemasonry, and to honour those who embody it. |
| **Why mentoring matters to Freemasonry** | Freemasonry has always been passed from person to person — its values, its ritual, its fellowship. A mentor is not merely a guide through the degrees; they are the living link between what Freemasonry has been and what it will become. |
| **Why mentoring matters to Hertfordshire specifically** | The Province of Hertfordshire takes pride in how it looks after its members — from the newest Entered Apprentice to the most experienced Past Master. Mentoring is central to that culture of care. It is how we ensure no member ever feels lost, overlooked, or unsupported. It is what makes Hertfordshire not just a Province, but a community. |
| **Why it is important to recognise exceptional mentoring** | Great mentors rarely seek recognition — that is part of what makes them great. But recognition matters: it tells those who give so much that their contribution has been seen and valued. It tells the wider Province that this is the standard we aspire to. And it tells every member that what they do — however quietly — can make a lasting difference to the life of another. |

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### PRODUCTION NOTES FOR DAN

- Film this segment before any nominees arrive — both speakers should be relaxed and unpressured
- Primary shot: both Mark and Wes seated or standing together, framed at chest height, looking at each other or to camera
- Capture individual close-up talking-head shots of each speaker for cutaways during the edit
- If possible, shoot a second informal take after the structured one
- This footage will open the video and set the entire tone

## 4. Filming Day — Schedule Template

Each filming session runs for 3 hours across 2 separate dates. Wes will book nominees in 20-minute intervals. The template below applies to both dates.

| Time Slot | Activity | Owner |
|---|---|---|
| **T-60 min** | Dan arrives — equipment setup, lighting check, sound test | **Dan** |
| **T-30 min** | Wes arrives — venue walkthrough, confirm run order | **Wes** |
| **T-15 min** | Welcome / green room ready for first nominee | **Wes** |
| **Slot 1** | Nominee 1 — welcome, settle, interview (30 min) | **Wes + Dan** |
| **Slot 2** | Nominee 2 — welcome, settle, interview (30 min) | **Wes + Dan** |
| **Slot 3** | Nominee 3 — welcome, settle, interview (30 min) | **Wes + Dan** |
| **Slot 4** | Nominee 4 — welcome, settle, interview (30 min) | **Wes + Dan** |
| **Slot 5** | Nominee 5 — welcome, settle, interview (30 min) | **Wes + Dan** |
| **Slot 6** | Nominee 6 — welcome, settle, interview (30 min) | **Wes + Dan** |
| **+15 min** | Equipment pack-down, debrief, footage backup | **Wes + Dan** |

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# 5. Interview Questions

## 5A. PRE-SUBMITTED QUESTIONS (SENT IN ADVANCE)

The following questions will be sent to each nominee prior to their filming slot. This allows them to reflect thoughtfully and arrive with confidence. Nominees should be encouraged to speak naturally — there is no need to memorise answers.

- **Who is the person you have nominated, and how did you first come to know them?**
  - Encourages a warm, narrative opening. Sets the scene for viewers. Although we wont use this for everyone, only finalists will be mentioned by name.
- **What specific qualities make this person an exceptional mentor?**
  - Invites concrete, personal reflection rather than generic praise.
- **Can you share a particular moment or example where their mentoring made a real difference to you?**
  - The most powerful question — specific stories create emotional resonance on camera.
- **How has their guidance shaped your journey within Freemasonry?**
  - Anchors the tribute within the Masonic context and the values of the Province.
- **What do you believe the role of a mentor means within our Province?**
  - Invites a broader reflection
- **Is there anything you would like to say directly to the person you have nominated?**
  - A powerful closing moment

## 5B. ORGANIC QUESTIONS (ON THE DAY — NOT PRE-SHARED)

The following two questions are reserved for on-camera use only. They are NOT to be sent in advance. Their purpose is to capture genuine, unscripted reactions — the kind of authenticity that elevates a production. Wes will choose the right moment to introduce each.

| Organic Question 1 | Organic Question 2 |
| --- | --- |
| *"If you could only use one single word to describe this person as a mentor — what would it be, and why?"* | *"When you think about what this person has given you, what is the one thing you have never quite been able to thank them for?"* |

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# 6. Pre-Production Checklist

## WES — COORDINATION & LOGISTICS

- Confirm filming dates with Cheshunt Masonic Halls and secure room booking
- Compile full list of nominees from received nominations
- Allow each nominee to book a 30-minute slot across the two filming dates with the online calendar booking system https://calendar.app.google/5rzwP9Q17ZqdVgu96
- Send written confirmation to each nominee including: date, time, venue, parking, and what to expect
- Send the pre-submitted question list (Section 4a) to nominees no later than 14 days before their slot
- Brief nominees: smart attire recommended, no need to memorise — conversational and natural is the goal
- Prepare a brief welcome script / opening remarks to put nominees at ease on arrival
- Maintain a master booking spreadsheet with nominee names, contact details, dates and times

# 7. Production — On the Day

## ARRIVING & SETTLING THE NOMINEE

- Wes and Mark greets each nominee on arrival and introduces them to Dan
- Offer a moment to settle — water, a brief overview of how the session will run
- Remind nominee: there are no wrong answers; this is a celebration, not a test
- Dan performs a brief sound/focus check with the nominee before recording begins

## INTERVIEW FLOW (PER SLOT)

- Pre-submitted questions: work through questions naturally, allowing digression and story — do not rush
- Mid-interview: Dan may signal if a re-take is needed due to technical issues
- Organic questions: Wes to deploy one or both organic questions at a suitable moment (see Section 4b)

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## 8. Post-Production — Editing (Dan O'Connell)

Dan will lead all editing, with Wes assisting where required. The following guidelines ensure a consistent, high-quality final production.

## 9. Communications — Nominee Invitation Template

The following outlines what should be included in the written invitation sent to each person who has submitted a nomination:

- Subject: Mentor Awards 2026 — Your Invitation to Participate in Our Tribute Video
- Opening: warm thank you for their nomination and explanation of the video's purpose
- Practical details: filming date, time slot, venue address, parking information
- What to expect: brief description of the interview format, approximate duration
- The six pre-submitted questions (Section 4a) — clearly listed
- Dress guidance: smart attire in keeping with the occasion
- Contact details for Wes for any questions or to reschedule

**Note: Organic questions not included in any written communication.**

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